WILDFIRE: AN UPDATED LOOK AT UTILITY RISK AND MITIGATION

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A Report by Eric Macomber, I. Avery Bick, Michael Wara, and Michael Mastrandrea

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EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Wildfires ignited by electric utility infrastructure pose a serious danger to communities across the United States. While the initial causes of the catastrophic fires which destroyed thousands of homes and other structures in the Los Angeles metropolitan area earlier this year remain under investigation,[1] affected homeowners have filed suit against several utilities, arguing that electric infrastructure ignited the fires that went on to burn through their neighborhoods.[2] These fires were unprecedented in the sense that they were among the most devastating wildfires in California history.[3] However, the risk of utility-ignited fires has been widely recognized in California for years, and the state has created a legal and regulatory regime specifically designed to address the risk of wildfires ignited by electric infrastructure.[4] In other regions across the United States, the situation is very different: states which have historically faced low catastrophic wildfire risk have seen their exposure to wildfires dramatically increase in recent years, creating an urgent need for new responses.[5] These responses will include wildfire mitigation programs implemented by utilities and overseen by their regulators.

Wildfire risk has continued to increase across North America as a result of a number of interrelated trends.[6] These include shifting weather conditions linked to climate change, which can cause fires to burn at higher intensity and spread more quickly across the landscape; historical fire suppression practices, which have caused flammable dead and dry vegetation to build up in many forested areas, increasing fire intensity; and development and land use patterns that have led vulnerable structures to be located in or near areas where fires are likely to occur, increasing the risk of catastrophic fires that spread from structure to structure and destroy entire communities.[7] As the potential danger of wildfires continues to increase, a wide range of stakeholders will need to find new approaches to measure and address their potential fire risk. In order to succeed, these approaches will need to reflect both the overall systemic challenges created by wildfire and the unique circumstances of specific regions and communities.

Electric utilities will play an important role in the society-wide process of adapting to increased wildfire risk, as well as the related process of building a more resilient electric system. In the near future, a massive amount of new electric infrastructure is needed, due to increasing demand for energy from sectors like data centers and the electrification of homes, businesses, and vehicles,[8] as well as the related need for increased transmission capacity to meet demand by bringing electricity from sites where it can be generated at large scale to the areas where it is consumed.[9] In order for this transition to take place, utilities will need to raise capital and enter into contract relationships to build infrastructure. However, wildfires complicate this core function of utilities, particularly for investor-owned utilities

1 Per fact sheet released by the California Department of Fire and Forestry (Cal Fire).

2 https://abcnews.go.com/US/homeowners-renters-sue-california-utility-company-eaton-fire/story?id=117636620; https://www.latimes.com/california/story/2025-03-27/ladwp-accused-of-hiding-role-power-lines-played-in-palisades-fire

3 https://abc7.com/post/biggest-most-destructive-fires-california-history/15787046/

4 https://www.dailynews.com/2025/03/02/eaton-fire-could-be-first-big-test-for-wildfire-fund-created-to-keep-utilities-out-of-bankruptcy/

5 https://www.theguardian.com/us-news/2025/apr/05/us-wildfires-cities-dangers

6 https://www.epa.gov/climate-indicators/climate-change-indicators-wildfires

7 https://www.preventionweb.net/news/la-fires-why-fast-wildfires-and-those-started-human-activities-are-more-destructive-and-harder

8 https://www.npr.org/2025/01/16/nx-s1-5251454/electricity-demand-data-centers-climate-change-natural-gas-fossil-fuel

9 https://www.nrel.gov/news/features/2024/national-transmission-planning-study.html

(IOUs).[10] Because the economic damages from a single catastrophic wildfire can reach into the billions of dollars, the possibility that a utility could be found liable for a fire as a result of its infrastructure causing an initial ignition creates serious financial challenges for utilities.[11] This makes IOUs riskier investments, which, in turn, makes it more difficult and expensive for them to access the capital needed to build infrastructure.[12] Therefore, an approach to wildfire mitigation which reduces the likelihood of electric infrastructure igniting catastrophic fires is key not only to protecting the safety of homes and communities threatened by fires, but also to the future development of the energy system. Because the costs that utilities incur as a result of both wildfire liability and infrastructure projects like mitigation plans are ultimately passed on to their customers in rates,[13] it is important that mitigation programs are conducted in a manner that is not only practical and timely, but also efficient and cost-effective.

This report is released as part of an ongoing project at the Stanford Climate and Energy Policy Program (CEPP), which has developed a framework for comparative assessment of electric utilities' relative wildfire risk exposure and mitigation plan development. In a previous report, we reviewed wildfire risk exposure and mitigation planning across IOUs operating in the Western United States as of the 2024 wildfire season.[14] In this report, we provide up-to-date information on surveyed IOUs as of the 2025 wildfire season, summarize early lessons learned in the aftermath of the catastrophic Los Angeles fires of January 2025, expand the scope of the survey to include IOUs operating in the Upper Midwest and Southeastern states, and update our representation of potential wildfire risk by incorporating a forward-looking proxy for future risk exposure. In the following sections, we explain the factual and legal background of this report in greater detail, describe the methods our team uses to assess risk exposure and wildfire mitigation plan development at the utility level, and summarize the conclusions reached by applying our framework to the surveyed utilities. Finally, we lay out the next steps planned for our overall project.

10 https://www.sciencedirect.com/topics/engineering/owned-utility

11 https://www.fitchratings.com/research/corporate-finance/us-electric-utilities-face-increased-credit-risk-from-wildfires-14-03-2025

12 https://www.utilitydive.com/news/nearly-100-utilities-credit-ratings-downgraded-since-2020-wildfires/730657/

13 https://www.publicadvocates.cpuc.ca.gov/press-room/reports-and-analyses/wildfire-cost-increases-of-california-electric-ious

14 https://stanford.io/4b8zFbh

BACKGROUND: RECENT DEVELOPMENTS IN UTILITY-IGNITED WILDFIRE

Shifting Liability Standards for Fires

As recent fires like the highly destructive Maui wildfires of 2023 have made clear, catastrophic wildfires are by no means a problem that is unique to the state of California or limited to areas where the risk of catastrophic fire has historically been elevated.[15] The following years have continued to see increasingly devastating fires in states and regions with relatively little recent catastrophic fire history; in 2025 alone, wildfires have occurred not only in California and the Western U.S. but also in Oklahoma,[16] Minnesota,[17] Nebraska,[18] New Jersey,[19] New York,[20] and North Carolina.[21] As catastrophic wildfires become a greater threat across more states, electric utilities' potential exposure to liability resulting from a fire ignited by their infrastructure is also rising, increasing the economic and strategic challenges that wildfire poses for utilities and the electric system.[22]

California has a unique legal framework which holds IOUs legally responsible for property damage resulting from all wildfires ignited by their infrastructure, regardless of whether the ignition was caused negligently.[23] This framework has historically been understood to make electric utilities liable for greater damages in the event of a fire than legal frameworks in other states would.[24] However, in recent years, electric utilities operating in several other states without comparable legal frameworks have also been found liable for billions of dollars in damages resulting from utility-ignited wildfires.[25] This may reflect a shifting, heightened expectation for the standard of care that electric utilities must display in order to avoid a finding of recklessness or negligence in the event of a fire—a change which could, in turn, affect the amount of potential risk exposure facing utilities. In the event that an electric utility is found to have acted in a grossly or criminally negligent or reckless manner, it may also be held liable for additional punitive and non-economic damages beyond compensatory damages for the property destroyed, further raising potential risk exposure and making the risk of insolvency even higher.[26] However, because few cases have been fully litigated, the standard of care that could demonstrate non-negligence on a utility's part remains unclear in many states.

15 https://www.nbcnews.com/specials/hawaii-fire-scientists-warn-escalating-wildfire-threat/index.html

16 https://www.newsweek.com/map-shows-impacted-counties-over-130-fires-blaze-across-oklahoma-2045383

17 https://www.newsweek.com/minnesota-camp-house-jenkins-creek-munger-shaw-fire-map-blaze-erupting-2071414

18 https://apnews.com/article/nebraska-where-is-wildfire-b5f192e969c24378b360e638cde5048f

19 https://www.washingtonpost.com/weather/2025/04/23/new-jersey-fire-acres-evacuations-ocean-county/

20 https://www.newsweek.com/new-york-wildfires-evacuations-underway-2041775

21 https://www.citizen-times.com/story/news/local/2025/04/01/western-nc-wildfires-hold-steady-after-rain-dampens-mountain-region/82754338007/

22 https://www.tdworld.com/vegetation-management/news/55235310/charles-river-associates-wildfires-threaten-utility-financial-stability

23 https://www.reuters.com/business/energy/california-utility-faces-billions-claims-fire-damage-even-if-it-did-nothing-2025-01-15/

24 https://www.publicadvocates.cpuc.ca.gov/-/media/cal-advocates-website/files/press-room/reports-and-analyses/230407-caladvocates-wildfire-safety-inverse-condemnation-policy-paper.pdf

25 https://grist.org/wildfires/utilities-lawsuits-wildfire-pg-e-pacificorp/

26 https://www.clearygottlieb.com/news-and-insights/publication-listing/utility-companies-with-wildfire-liability-exposure-pose-unique-considerations-for-investors

One response to the challenges that growing wildfire risk and legal uncertainty have created for the electric system has been the advancement of legislation at the state level to create new liability standards that are more protective of electric utilities,[27] including bills which would create a presumption of non-negligence for electric utilities that implement wildfire mitigation plans compliant with state regulatory requirements.[28] Other approaches to limiting electric utilities' exposure to wildfire risk include the creation of public funds to reimburse participating utilities for wildfire damages that exceed a certain amount, a strategy which has been implemented at the state level in California and Utah.[29] In collaboration with the Brookings Institution, members of the Climate and Energy Policy Program have proposed a federal wildfire backstop that could play a similar role at the national level.[30] Whatever form these approaches take, utility liability frameworks should be designed in order to balance the need for utilities to remain financially stable with the need for utilities to take reasonable precautions to prevent their infrastructure from igniting catastrophic wildfires.

Increasing use of Public Safety Power Shutoffs (PSPS)

The fire season of 2024 saw the expanded use of public safety power shutoffs (PSPS), a utility wildfire mitigation tool which can prevent ignitions by preemptively deenergizing electric infrastructure in high fire-risk areas during dangerous conditions.[31] For instance, Idaho Power, in Idaho,[32] and Xcel Energy, in Colorado,[33] each implemented these shutoffs for the first time in 2024. The increasing use of PSPS may be an example of shifting norms regarding the standard of care required of electric utilities for wildfire mitigation, as described above. Although litigation in the case is still in progress,[34] an Oregon jury found in 2023 that PacifiCorp acted recklessly and with gross negligence during the 2020 Labor Day wildfires because it did not preemptively deenergize its infrastructure during high fire-risk conditions.[35] Therefore, it's conceivable that utilities in some states may need to demonstrate that they have implemented plans to use wildfire mitigation tools, possibly including PSPS, in order to avoid a finding of negligence in the event of a fire linked to their infrastructure.

As wildfire risk continues to increase across much of the United States, electric utilities in states beyond those that have recently experienced catastrophic fires may be incentivized to create PSPS plans, both in order to prevent ignitions and in order to avoid a finding of liability in the event of an ignition. However, because PSPS events inherently reduce electric reliability and can cause negative consequences for customers whose power is shut off, particularly during extreme weather events and for customers using critical medical devices that require electricity,[36] the fire-risk benefits of each individual use of PSPS should be weighed against these other potential risks. To facilitate

27 https://stateline.org/2025/04/22/as-wildfires-intensify-utilities-want-liability-protections-but-then-who-pays/

28 https://www.eenews.net/articles/warren-buffetts-empire-is-shaping-wildfire-laws-to-shield-utilities/

29 https://www.cawildfirefund.com/; https://le.utah.gov/xcode/Title54/Chapter24/C54-24-P3_2024050120240501.pdf

30 https://www.brookings.edu/articles/climate-change-and-utility-wildfire-risk-a-proposal-for-a-federal-backstop/

31 https://www.cpuc.ca.gov/PSPS/

32 https://www.kivitv.com/downtown-boise/safety-has-to-come-first-idaho-power-reflects-on-first-ever-public-safety-power-shutoff-event

33 https://newsroom.xcelenergy.com/news/xcel-energy-to-proceed-with-public-safety-power-shutoffs-MCRIETLUTEYFEQRPVWYZKIGNMPDA

34 https://www.opb.org/article/2025/04/02/pacificorp-appeals-class-action-ruling-over-2020-oregon-wildfires/

35 https://apnews.com/article/wildfires-utility-company-berkshire-hathaway-warren-buffett-ff26bcf69a111e7343e7f806c6c7c937

36 https://www.cpuc.ca.gov/consumer-support/psps/evolution-of-psps-guidelines

this, PSPS plans should be carefully coordinated between utilities, regulators, and affected stakeholders, including both customers and local governments, to ensure that the use of PSPS does not interfere with emergency response or other critical uses. For the same reason, electric utilities' PSPS plans should also include programs to mitigate the potential negative impacts of PSPS events when they do occur, such as the provision of backup power for critical users and the use of improved system settings to limit the duration and size of shutoffs.

Lessons from the 2025 Los Angeles Wildfires

The January 2025 fires in the Los Angeles area were among the most devastating fires in California history. Their causes are still under investigation; however, both the Palisades Fire, which affected the area of Pacific Palisades, and the Eaton Fire, which affected the area of Altadena, were initially understood to have potential links to electric utility infrastructure. Both fires took place on days when strong seasonal winds were expected to affect the area after a period of drought.[37] These conditions increase the possibility that electric infrastructure could ignite a fire, because they make it more likely for high winds to compromise electric infrastructure or for vegetation to come into contact with electric infrastructure and create a spark.[38] The same conditions also increase the risk that an ignition could lead to a severe or catastrophic fire, because high winds and the presence of dead or dry vegetation can cause a fire to spread more quickly and burn at a higher temperature.[39]

The Palisades Fire was ignited in hilly shrubland near the coastal neighborhood of Pacific Palisades.[40] While multiple potential ignition sources are possible, including arson or a reignition of smoldering embers from partially extinguished fires originally ignited by New Year's Eve fireworks, the area also was the site of an overhead power line operated by the Los Angeles Department of Water and Power (LADWP), the city's public electric utility, which could potentially have caused an ignition.[41] LADWP has stated that, although the line was deactivated years prior to the fire, it had since been reactivated and was energized on the day of the fire.[42] As a public utility, the LADWP is required to file Wildfire Mitigation Plans (WMPs) by state law,[43] but does not participate in the same regulatory review process as the state's IOUs,[44] and, as of its most recent WMP filing, did not have a PSPS plan in place.[45] While the ultimate causes of the fire are still unknown, litigation was filed in March 2025 accusing LADWP of igniting or exacerbating the fire.[46]

The Eaton fire was ignited in Eaton Canyon in the foothills of the San Gabriel Mountains northeast of Los Angeles, a corridor used for several overhead transmission lines which pass near parks and residential neighborhoods. Early videos made public after the fire showed flames below a Southern California Edison (SCE) transmission tower.[47]

37 https://www.latimes.com/california/story/2025-01-13/particularly-dangerous-situation-red-flag-fire-weather-warning-issued-for-l-a-ventura-counties
38 https://wfca.com/wildfire-articles/power-lines-and-wildfires/
39 https://ibhs1.wpenginepowered.com/wp-content/uploads/2025-LAFires-EarlyFieldObservations.pdf#page=2
40 https://www.latimes.com/california/story/2025-01-12/on-an-ocean-view-trail-questions-swirl-about-what-and-who-started-palisades-fire
41 https://www.nytimes.com/2025/01/13/us/palisades-fire-cause-ignition-point-site.html
42 https://www.ladwpnews.com/ladwp-statement-regarding-palisades-fire-litigation/
43 https://codes.findlaw.com/ca/public-utilities-code/puc-sect-8387/
44 https://energysafety.ca.gov/what-we-do/wildfire-safety-advisory-board/investor-owned-utility-wildfire-mitigation-plans/
45 https://www.ladwp.com/sites/default/files/2024-06/2024%20LADWP%20Wildfire%20Mitigation%20Plan.pdf#page=9
46 https://www.dailyjournal.com/articles/384513-lawsuits-claim-ladwp-power-lines-caused-palisades-fire-claim-cover-up
47 https://www.nbcbayarea.com/investigations/eaton-fire-los-angeles-cause-video/3786108/

Fluctuations in SCE-supplied electric power detected by home monitors were consistent with a fault occurring in the transmission infrastructure in Eaton Canyon, which could be caused by an object making contact with a power line.[48] Later inspections of the site showed scorch marks consistent with an ignition on a section of overhead transmission line that had been deactivated years earlier by SCE; one possible explanation for this series of events is that a fault caused power to surge and travel from an energized SCE line to the deactivated infrastructure, energizing it and creating sparks that ignited the fire.[49] As an IOU, SCE files a WMP plan on a regular basis with state regulators, including a PSPS plan that incorporates its transmission infrastructure,[50] but had chosen on the day of the ignition not to preemptively deenergize its transmission lines in Eaton Canyon.[51] As with the Palisades fire, the ultimate cause of the Eaton fire is still unknown, but litigation was filed in March 2025 accusing SCE of igniting the fire.[52] SCE transmission infrastructure was also implicated in the ignition of the Hurst fire, a smaller fire which occurred in the Los Angeles area at the same time as the Eaton and Palisades Fires.[53]

While it is too soon to draw strong conclusions from the Los Angeles fires that can be applied to utility wildfire mitigation more generally, it is notable that, if electric utility infrastructure is determined to have caused an ignition in either the Eaton Fire or the Palisades Fire, the power lines in question will be of a type that is beyond the scope of many wildfire mitigation plans and regulations. Public utilities like LADWP, whose infrastructure is potentially implicated in the Palisades Fire, are in many cases not subject to the same legal and regulatory requirements for wildfire mitigation that apply to IOUs.[54] Even for IOUs like SCE, which are required or incentivized to create WMPs in several states, mitigation plans generally prioritize measures that reduce the risk of ignitions caused by lower-voltage distribution infrastructure—which is generally understood to face relatively higher ignition risk, because of its less robust construction and lower clearances from the ground and vegetation—as opposed to higher-voltage transmission infrastructure of the type implicated in the Eaton and Hurst fires.[55] While SCE's WMP included a PSPS plan for its transmission infrastructure, PSPS was not implemented in the transmission lines over Eaton Canyon, and recent revisions to the utility's procedures to ensure its deactivated infrastructure does not ignite a fire have not been released to the public.[56] Therefore, one early lesson of the Los Angeles fires is that the scope of wildfire mitigation analysis should be drawn both more broadly and more deeply, in order to properly include the full range of utilities and electric infrastructure that have the potential to ignite a catastrophic fire, the conditions that can make such an ignition more likely, and the measures that electric utilities can take to assess and mitigate the risk of catastrophic fire across all of their infrastructure.

48 https://www.nytimes.com/2025/03/18/business/energy-environment/socal-edison-eaton-fire.html

49 https://www.washingtonpost.com/weather/2025/02/01/eaton-fire-decommissioned-power-line/

50 https://www.sce.com/sites/default/files/AEM/Wildfire%20Mitigation%20Plan/2023-2025/SCE%202023-2025%20WMP%20R3.1%20(November%2014%2C%202024).pdf#page=633

51 https://www.utilitydive.com/news/southern-california-edison-eix-wildfire-eaton-hurst/739622/

52 https://internationalfireandsafetyjournal.com/eaton-fire-lawsuit-targets-southern-california-edison-over-wildfire-damage/

53 https://thehdpost.com/2025/02/07/edison-reports-that-equipment-may-have-started-hurst-fire-investigation-is-still-ongoing-for-eaton-fire/

54 https://insight.factset.com/electric-utility-regulation-wildfire-mitigation

55 https://blog.ucs.org/paul-arbaje/wildfires-and-power-grid-failures-continue-to-fuel-each-other/

56 https://www.latimes.com/california/story/2025-04-10/southern-california-edison-policy-change-eaton-fire

OUR PROJECT: BUILDING A FRAMEWORK TO ASSESS AND QUANTIFY UTILITY WILDFIRE RISK AND MITIGATION

Building on our earlier report, we aim to collect up-to-date, state-specific information on the wildfire risk exposure and wildfire mitigation plan development of investor-owned electric utilities operating in the surveyed states. For this report, we create a framework to collect WMP information for each IOU at the state level, then interpret this data using public datasets representing the geographical locations of utility service territories and potential wildfire risk. Based on this analysis, we create a series of figures representing potential wildfire risk and mitigation maturity at the state and utility level for surveyed utilities. We believe that representing the information collected by our project in this way can help to represent where utility wildfire mitigation capacity is being built and illustrate where more mitigation development may be needed. Collecting information on a regular basis will also help to track the development of each included utility's mitigation program over time. Additionally, we hope to expand our methodology in the future to include public utilities and electric co-operatives; to continue to improve our representation of potential wildfire risk exposure; and to distinguish between the different locations and risk profiles of distribution and transmission infrastructure.

Assessing Exposure to Wildfire Risk by Utility

Our previous report used the wildfire risk rating assigned at the county level by the U.S. Federal Emergency Management Agency's Wildfire Risk Index[57] as a proxy for risk exposure within a utility's service territory. However, as discussed in the previous report, the Wildfire Risk Index is primarily based on historical data, and, therefore, using this tool to evaluate future risk exposure and make operational decisions relating to wildfire mitigation may understate potential wildfire risk, especially in areas where the risk of catastrophic fires has increased in the recent past or is likely to increase in the near future. To better reflect the forward-looking nature of wildfire risk mitigation, this iteration of the project uses the Wildfire Hazard Potential (WHP) dataset developed by the United States Forest Service (USFS)[58]—which incorporates statistical modeling of data on wildfire likelihood and intensity, the location of burnable vegetation, and historical ignition locations—to illustrate whether a given location within a utility's service territory is at higher relative risk of difficult-to-manage wildfire. Because this dataset was created as a long-term planning tool to prioritize wildfire mitigation, we use WHP as a proxy for areas within a utility's service territory where wildfire mitigation may be needed. However, we note that, in addition to the inherent limitations of statistical modeling, the data included are limited in the sense that they do not include projected near-term weather conditions and that they do not include the locations of structures or resiliency at the home and community level, which may limit their applicability to near-term decision-making and the risk of fires affecting structures in more developed urban areas.[59]

57 https://hazards.fema.gov/nri/wildfire

58 https://wildfirerisk.org/download/

59 https://research.fs.usda.gov/firelab/products/dataandtools/wildfire-hazard-potential. For example, recent fires in Minnesota destroyed structures in areas that are rated at relatively low to moderate WHP: https://www.nytimes.com/2025/05/17/us/minnesota-wildfires-climate-change.html

Assessing Wildfire Mitigation Plan (WMP) Maturity by Utility

As in our previous report, we assess WMP maturity by collecting information on a set of binary (yes-or-no) criteria which relate to specific elements of wildfire mitigation, focusing on tools that can be implemented to reduce fire risk in the near term while utilities and regulators develop longer-term plans. This information is collected at a state- and utility-specific level from each of the utilities included in our survey. Based on these criteria, we then assign each utility a state-specific rating for overall WMP maturity along a three-tier scale. While the tier system has not changed substantially from the previous iteration of this project, we have revised the individual criteria used to collect information on each utility.

WMP Development Criteria

As described above, our WMP development criteria are largely identical to the criteria used in our earlier report. Included below are abbreviated versions of these criteria, for which full descriptions can be found in the original document.[60] However, in order to distinguish between two separate approaches to mitigation relating to infrastructure system settings, the third criterion from the original report, *"Protective Equipment and Device Settings (PEDS) / Fast-Trip"*, has been replaced with two separate criteria, "*Reclosing Disabled in High Fire-Risk Conditions"* and "*Protective Equipment and Device Settings (PEDS) / Fast-Trip"*, which are described below.

1. Wildfire Mitigation Plan (WMP) Created & Released

This criterion is applicable to utilities that have drafted and released information pertaining to a wildfire mitigation plan (WMP) detailing their efforts to mitigate wildfire risk within their service territories, including but not limited to inspections and maintenance of utility infrastructure, vegetation management, grid operations, and system hardening.

2. Weather Stations / Other First-Party Meteorological Resources

This criterion is applicable to utilities that have deployed weather stations or other first-party meteorological resources on their infrastructure in order to improve utility-wide situational awareness and risk assessment.

3. Reclosing Disabled in High Fire-Risk Conditions

This criterion is applicable to utilities that have implemented device settings to reduce the likelihood of ignitions occurring as a result of their electric infrastructure automatically reclosing after a fault during high fire-risk conditions. In normal operations, electric utilities use automatic reclosing devices in order to quickly reenergize lines and restore service after a fault.[61] However, automatic reclosing may cause infrastructure to spark, which, in high fire-risk conditions, increases the likelihood of an ignition that could lead to a catastrophic wildfire. Because disabling or limiting automatic reclosing reduces this risk, utilities that modify system settings on their electric infrastructure in order to disable or limit automatic reclosing in high fire-risk conditions meet this criterion.

60 https://woodsinstitute.stanford.edu/system/files/publications/Woods_CEPP_Wildire_White_Paper_FINAL.pdf#page=12

61 https://spectrum.ieee.org/utilities-probed-as-potential-cause-of-california-fires

4. Protective Equipment and Device Settings (PEDS) / Fast-Trip

This criterion is applicable to utilities that have implemented device settings to lower the risk of electric infrastructure ignitions occurring during high fire-risk conditions. Utilities that meet this criterion use "fast-trip" settings which allow for faster deenergization of equipment when a fault is detected, collectively categorized by the California Public Utilities Commission (CPUC) as Protective Equipment and Device Settings (PEDS).[62] Because these features can significantly reduce the risk of utility infrastructure igniting catastrophic wildfires as a result of a fault, a utility which has implemented these more sensitive settings on its infrastructure meets this criterion. This criterion is distinct from the prior criterion because more sensitive device settings can prevent an initial ignition due to a fault; in contrast, disabling reclosing reduces the risk of ignitions occurring as a result of reclosing attempts following a fault, but not the risk of an ignition from the fault itself.

5. Operational Public Safety Power Shutoff (PSPS) Plan

This criterion is applicable to utilities that have drafted and released information pertaining to a public safety power shutoff (PSPS) plan to deenergize their electric infrastructure in order to prevent ignitions during high fire-risk conditions. For the purposes of this project, a PSPS plan which is implemented on either distribution or transmission infrastructure meets this criterion.

6. Shutoff Impact Mitigation (e.g. sectionalization, on-site generation/storage, identification and advanced notification to medical baseline customers)

This criterion is applicable to utilities that have implemented measures to limit either the scope (in terms of geographical size, duration, and number of users affected) or the impact (in terms of disruption of essential services) of shutoffs caused by more protective systems settings and PSPS events.

WMP Maturity Tiers

As in our previous report, we assign each surveyed utility a WMP maturity tier based on its implementation of the near-term steps in mitigation development included in our criteria. As before, the highest tier in our framework is broadly analogous to the level of WMP development obtained by California IOUs in the recent past. However, it is important to note that California utilities remain exposed to significant wildfire risk and that utilities operating in other states can and should diverge from the approach taken in California in order to respond to their unique circumstances.

Tier 3: No WMP, no PSPS plan, or no public information available

The lowest tier in our maturity analysis applies to utilities that have not created a WMP, lack an operational PSPS program, or have not made information on these plans publicly available. This is a deliberately low threshold, set to reflect the understanding that many utilities have not yet taken these initial steps. Distinguishing between utilities on this basis also reflects our understanding that even relatively modest efforts to assess and mitigate wildfire risk can have substantial effects, both on a utility's exposure to wildfire risk and on third parties' ability to accurately assess the utility's wildfire risk.

62 https://www.cpuc.ca.gov/industries-and-topics/wildfires/pacific-gas-and-electric-heightened-equipment-sensitivity-wildfire-mitigation-program

Tier 2: WMP & PSPS plan, but otherwise incomplete

The second threshold in our maturity analysis applies to utilities that have made WMPs publicly available and have implemented operational PSPS plans, but have not fully implemented the other mitigation efforts described in our criteria. Our requirement that utilities implement a PSPS plan in order to be included in this tier reflects the increasing use of PSPS and potential expectation that a PSPS plan is part of the standard of care for utilities operating in areas potentially exposed to elevated wildfire risk.

Tier 1: WMP & PSPS plan, all other criteria met

The highest threshold in our maturity analysis applies to utilities that have created and published a WMP and PSPS plan, including the implementation of meteorological resources to understand fire risk, system settings to further reduce wildfire risk, and mitigation efforts to reduce the negative impact on reliability of shutoffs caused by PEDS and PSPS. Utilities included in this tier have met the criteria for Tier 2, and have additionally implemented at least some degree of the other mitigation efforts described in our criteria.

Table 1: Utility WMP Development Criteria & Maturity Tiers

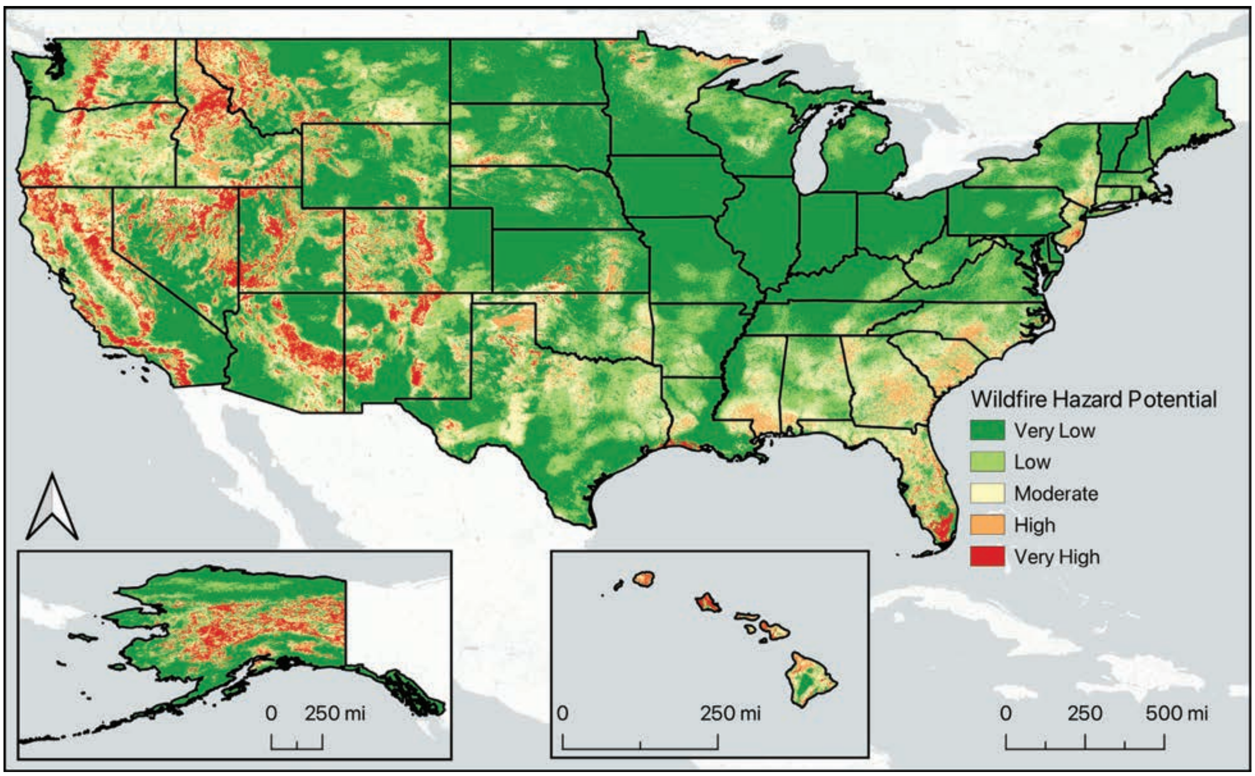
	1: WMP Created?	2: Weather stations / first-party meteorological resources?	3: Reclosing disabled in high fire-risk conditions?	3: Protective Equipment & Device Settings (PEDS) / Fast-Trip?	4: Operational PSPS Plan?	5: Shutoff mitigation?
Tier 3: No WMP, no PSPS plan, or no public information available	Not created or no public plan available	Not created or no public plan available	Not created or no public plan available	Not created or no public plan available	Not created or implemented, utility has no operational strategy to implement PSPS, or no public plan available	Not created or no public plan available
Tier 2: WMP & PSPS plan, but incomplete PEDS / shutoff mitigation	WMP created and published	May or may not be implemented	May or may not be implemented	May or may not be implemented	PSPS plan created and implemented	May or may not be implemented
Tier 1: WMP & PSPS plan, PEDS & shutoff mitigation measures in place	WMP created and published	Implemented, including first-party deployment of meteorological resources	Implemented	Implemented, including faster trip settings	PSPS plan created and implemented	Implemented to some extent (e.g. sectionalization, on-site generation/ storage, identification and advanced notification to medical baseline customers)

Visualizing Investor-Owned Utility Risk Exposure & WMP Maturity

The following figures apply our framework for assessing wildfire risk and rating WMP maturity to the group of investor-owned utilities surveyed for this report. As stated in the "Our Project: Building a Framework to Assess and Quantify Utility Wildfire Risk and Mitigation" section above, we believe these illustrations can help to represent where utility wildfire mitigation capacity is being built and where more mitigation development may be needed. However, the limitations described in the "Assessing Exposure to Wildfire Risk by Utility" section above apply to these figures as well, which should likewise not be taken as fully accurate or used for planning purposes. These data are also available as an interactive map here and in ArcGIS format here.

Figure 1: Wildfire Hazard Potential (WHP)

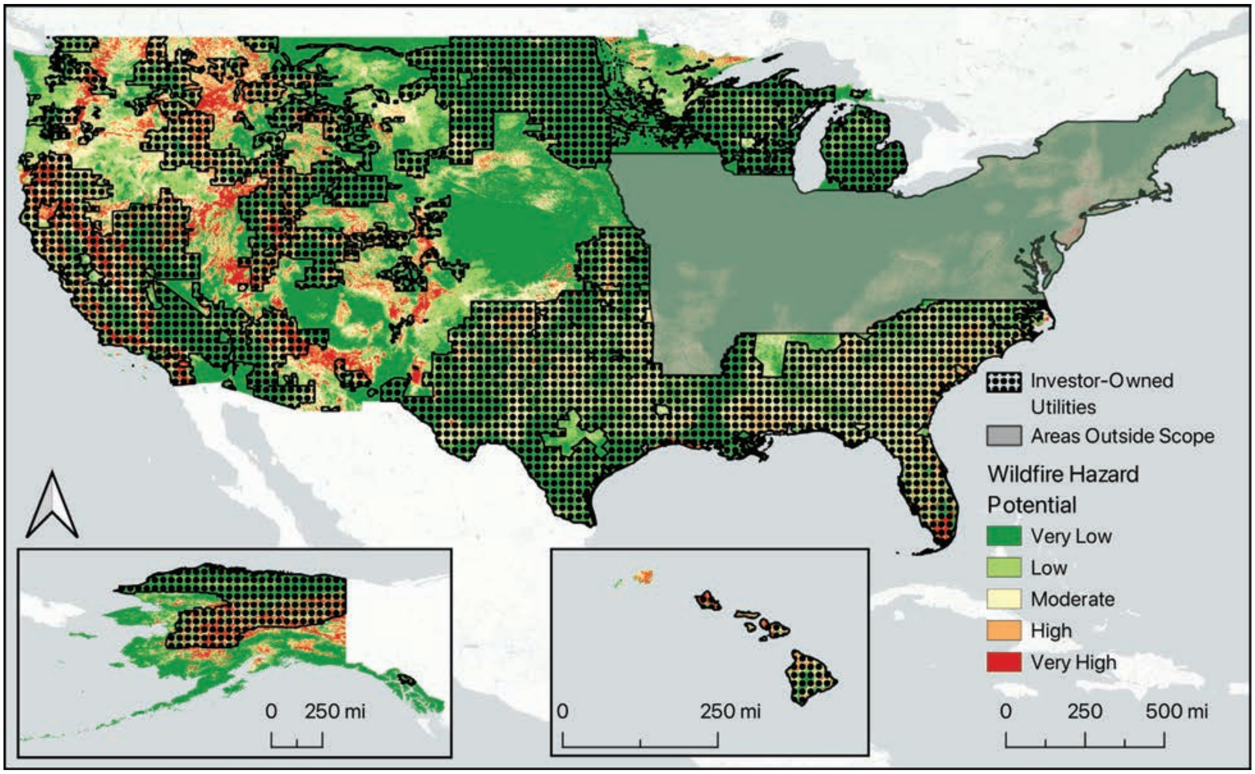
The following figure represents the USFS' Wildfire Hazard Potential ratings across the United States, visually representing where severe wildfires are more likely to occur according to the USFS' modeling as described in "Assessing Exposure to Wildfire Risk by Utility" above.[63]



63 WHP data from USFS https://wildfirerisk.org/download/. Basemap ©CARTO ©OpenMapTiles ©OpenStreetMap contributors.

Figure 2: WHP Within Service Territories of Surveyed IOUs

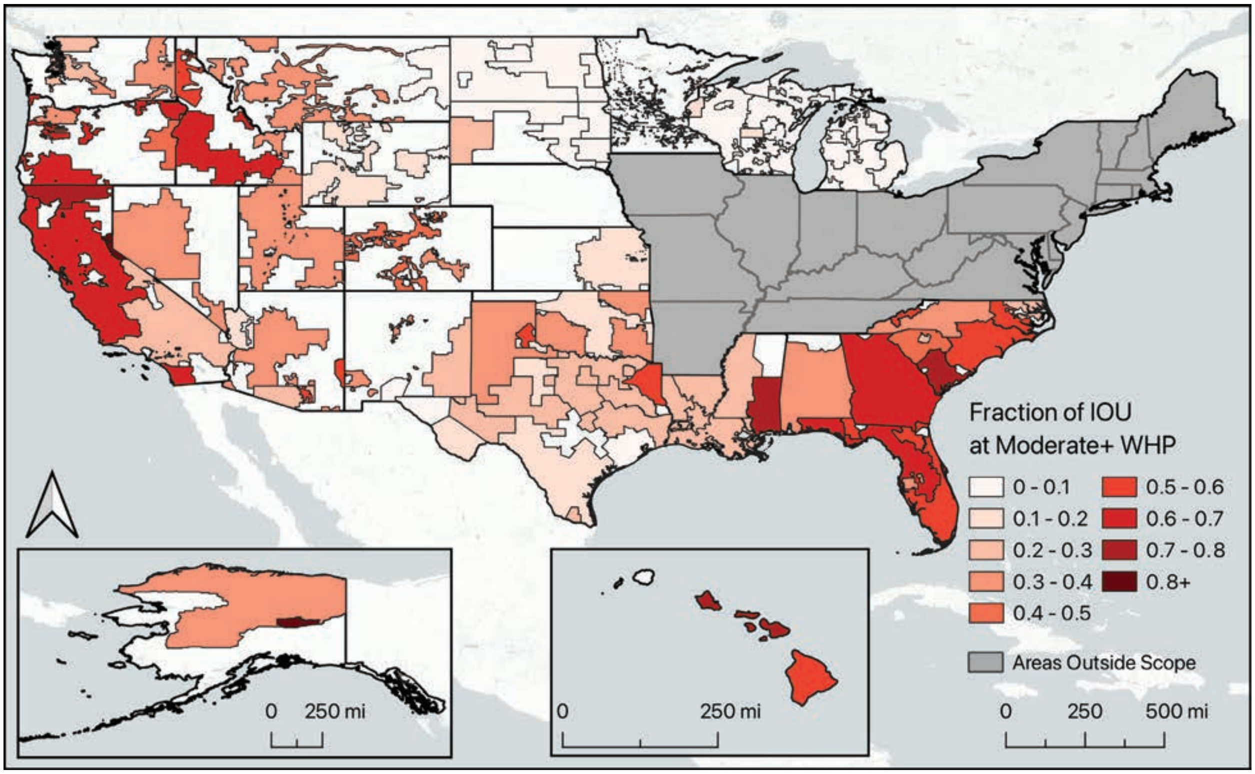
The following figure superimposes the service territories of the investor-owned utilities surveyed in this report over the representation of WHP in the previous figure to illustrate where these IOUs' service territories may overlap with areas at elevated risk of wildfire.[64]



64 Electric Retail Service Territory data from EIA https://atlas.eia.gov/datasets/4ee07fd24c0b47578c5b11017a7eb3ac_0/explore. WHP data from USFS https://wildfirerisk.org/download/. Basemap ©CARTO ©OpenMapTiles ©OpenStreetMap contributors.

Figure 3: Fraction of Service Territory at Moderate or Higher WHP for Surveyed IOUs

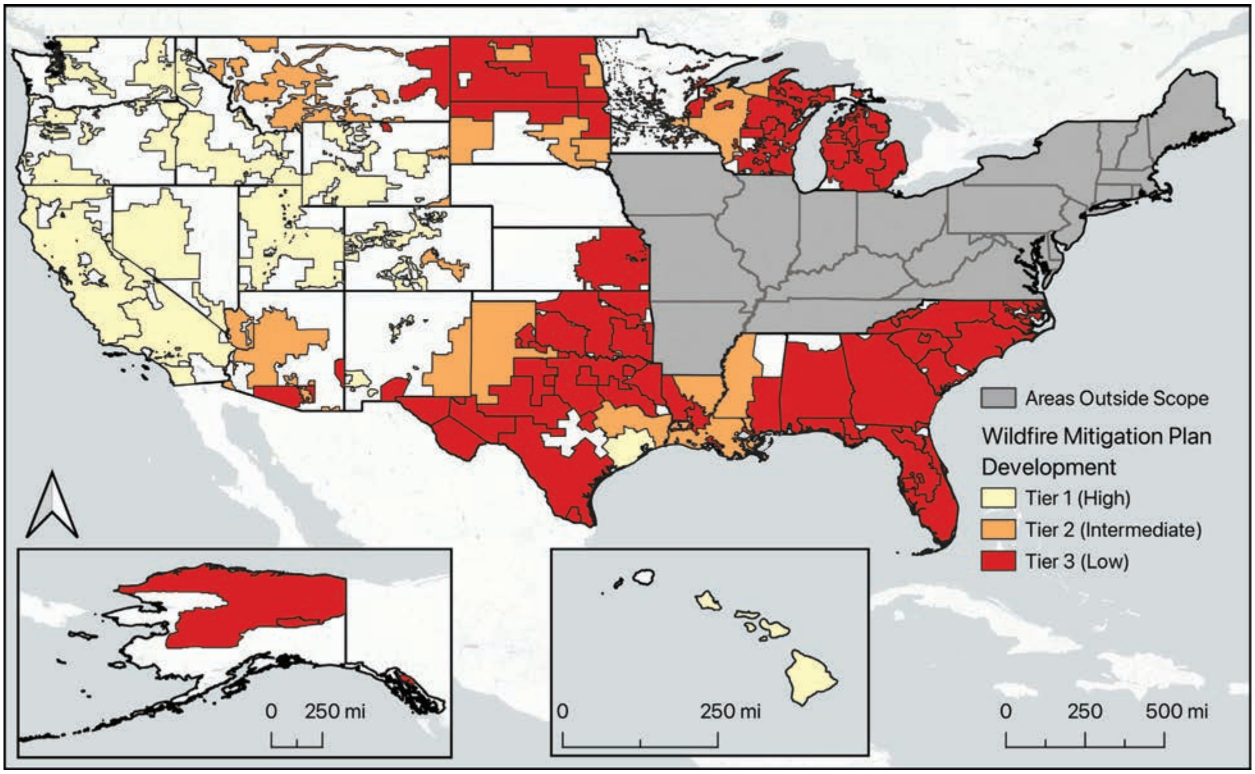
The following figure represents the service territories of the investor-owned utilities surveyed in this report with color coding corresponding to the fraction of the service territory within each state with a WHP rating of moderate or greater, indicating which utilities may be exposed to severe wildfire risk in a greater proportion of their service territory.[65]



65 Electric Retail Service Territory data from EIA https://atlas.eia.gov/datasets/4ee07fd24c0b47578c5b11017a7eb3ac_0/explore. WHP data from USFS https://wildfirerisk.org/download/. Basemap ©CARTO ©OpenMapTiles ©OpenStreetMap contributors.

Figure 4: WMP Maturity Ratings of Surveyed IOUs

The following figure represents the service territories of the investor-owned utilities surveyed in this report with color coding corresponding to the WMP maturity rating assigned to the IOU at the state level within our framework, indicating which utilities have a relatively higher level of WMP development.[66]



66 Electric Retail Service Territory data from EIA https://atlas.eia.gov/datasets/4ee07fd24c0b47578c5b11017a7eb3ac_0/explore. Basemap ©CARTO ©OpenMapTiles ©OpenStreetMap contributors.

CONCLUSIONS

As noted in our initial 2024 report, utility-ignited wildfire risk can no longer be ignored by electric utilities, regulators and lawmakers, or the communities they serve. One year later, significant progress in WMP development has been made among the Western IOUs included in our original survey. WMP maturity remains comparatively high for IOUs in states like California, Nevada, Oregon, and Utah that have encouraged utility wildfire mitigation through law or regulation, as well as among IOUs that have recently experienced wildfire either directly, like Hawaiian Electric, or through a corporate affiliate. However, in the Gulf Coast, Southeast, and Upper Midwest, comparatively few IOUs have implemented the most fundamental steps in our wildfire mitigation framework, even in areas that face significant potential wildfire risk. One possible reason for the apparent gap between electric utilities' exposure to wildfire risk and their WMP development is the fact that regulatory approval to implement mitigation measures can be difficult for utilities to obtain in states with relatively little recent history of catastrophic wildfires, in large part due to concerns about potential adverse effects on affordability and reliability. These concerns are particularly acute for smaller electric utilities, because spending on programs like wildfire mitigation has a larger impact on each individual customer's rates for utilities with fewer overall ratepayers. However, as recent years have shown, when action is not taken in advance to mitigate the risk of wildfires, catastrophic fires ultimately create much higher and more devastating costs for both utilities and society at large.

The optimal approach to electric utility wildfire mitigation development will be unique for each state and utility, and developing fully mature approaches to wildfire risk will take years. However, in the near term, a cohesive and cost-effective approach to wildfire risk that prevents the most catastrophic fires, stabilizes IOUs' finances, and maintains customers' access to safe, reliable, and affordable power will be crucial in order to ensure the continuing viability of the overall electric system. Other types of electric utilities that are potentially exposed to wildfire risk, such as publicly owned utilities and rural electric cooperatives, should also take near-term measures to reduce the likelihood of their infrastructure igniting a catastrophic fire. Electric utilities and their regulators should aim to reduce wildfire risk, including risk from potential sources of ignitions like deactivated transmission infrastructure that may not have been considered in existing WMPs, while simultaneously working to improve electricity affordability and reliability over the long term.

NEXT STEPS

As an ongoing project, we plan to continue collecting information on electric utilities' wildfire risk exposure and WMP development on a regular basis and to continue to report on our findings. Going forward, we also plan to continue expanding the scope of the surveyed utilities to include electric utilities in more states, as well as non-investor-owned electric utilities such as public utilities and rural electric cooperatives. This reflects our understanding that wildfire risk is rising across North America, along with the fact that all electric utilities are potentially exposed to some degree of wildfire risk, regardless of their ownership structure. In order to better represent relative wildfire risk exposure, we plan to continue refining our proxy for wildfire risk using a greater variety of datasets and risk modeling tools. To reflect the distinct ignition risk profiles of different types of electric infrastructure, we hope to refine our framework and dataset to distinguish between multiple varieties of high- and low-voltage distribution and transmission infrastructure, as well as to represent how utilities may have implemented mitigation plans differently across these different sections of their infrastructure. We also plan to continue developing the criteria and maturity tiers used to assess relative WMP maturity, potentially including the addition of further tiers to rank mitigation development beyond the highest level of maturity represented at this point in the project.


Photo credit: Jorge Villalba, iStock.

APPENDIX 1: ACRONYMS

CEPP	Climate and Energy Policy Program
CPUC	California Public Utilities Commission
EIA	Energy Information Administration
IOU	Investor-Owned Utility
LADWP	Los Angeles Department of Water and Power
PEDS	Protective Equipment and Device Settings
PG&E	Pacific Gas & Electric Company
PSPS	Public Safety Power Shutoff
SCE	Southern California Edison
USFS	United States Forest Service
WHP	Wildfire Hazard Potential
WMP	Wildfire Mitigation Plan

APPENDIX 2: METHODS

Identifying Wildfire Risk Exposure

To approximate wildfire risk exposure at the utility level in a state-specific manner, we applied WHP data to IOU vectors as represented by the United Staes Energy Information Administration (EIA)'s Electric Retail Service Territories map.[67] We first uploaded the contiguous United States, Alaska, and Hawaii 30 meter resolution WHP rasters to a cloud compute cluster. Using Python and rasterio, we then downsampled each to 300 meter resolution with bilinear resampling to reduce computational time, then reprojected all rasters to the NAD83 datum and Conus Albers projection (EPSG:5070). The three rasters were mosaicked into a single WHP raster and downloaded. From this mosaicked raster, we created a binary raster by setting all WHP values above 156 equal to 1 and those less than or equal to 156 as 0. This threshold of 156 was set by Dillon et. al. 2015[68] as the upper limit of "Low to Moderate Risk" values for WHP. Thus, this binary raster represents whether a WHP pixel has Moderate or greater risk.

Next, IOU service territory vectors and state borders[69] were reprojected to EPSG:5070. Using the Snap geometries to layer tool in QGIS, the borders of IOUs were snapped to state borders if they were within 1000 meters. We then used the Split by lines tool to split IOU geometries by state borders. Manual review of the split IOU geometries was performed and any invalid IOU geometries created erroneously along state borders were deleted. Finally, we performed zonal statistics to calculate the percentage of each IOU covered by moderate or greater WHP, as described above.

67 https://atlas.eia.gov/datasets/4ee07fd24c0b47578c5b11017a7eb3ac_0/explore

68 https://www.fs.usda.gov/rm/pubs/rmrs_p073/rmrs_p073_060_076.pdf

69 https://www.census.gov/geographies/mapping-files/time-series/geo/carto-boundary-file.html

State	IOU	1. WMP information created & released?	2. Weather stations / other first-party meteorological resources?	3. Reclosing disabled in high fire-risk conditions?	4. Protective Equipment & Device Settings (PEDS) / Fast-Trip?	5. Operational PSPS plan?	6. Shutoff impact mitigation?	WMP Maturity Tier
†Transmission-only utility								
Alabama	Alabama Power Company	No public plan available	No public plan available	No public plan available	No public plan available	No public plan available	No public plan available (weather center with tips for residents)	3: No WMP, no PSPS plan, or no public information available
Alaska	Avista Utilities (Alaska) / Alaska Electric Light & Power Company	No public Alaska plan available (operations are separate from other Avista utilities)	Yes (per personal communication, utility owns and maintains 3 weather stations and partners with Alaska DOT on a 4th station)	No (per personal communication)	No (per personal communication)	No (per personal communication)	No (per personal communication)	3: No WMP, no PSPS plan, or no public information available
	G & K, Inc.	No public plan available	No public plan available	No public plan available	No public plan available	No public plan available	No public plan available	3: No WMP, no PSPS plan, or no public information available
	TDX Power	No public plan available	No public plan available	No public plan available	No public plan available	No public plan available	No public plan available	3: No WMP, no PSPS plan, or no public information available
Arizona	Ajo Improvement Company	No public plan available	No public plan available	No public plan available	No public plan available	No public plan available	No public plan available	3: No WMP, no PSPS plan, or no public information available
	Arizona Public Service	Yes	Yes	Yes	No (PEDS upgrades planned)	Yes	Yes (collaborating with county emergency managers to provide cooling / charging resources & advanced notification of shutoffs; advance identification & communication with critical customers)	2: WMP & PSPS plan, but otherwise incomplete
	Fortis (Arizona) / UNS Energy / Tucson Electric Power Company	Yes	No (state and federal wildfire and emergency management websites used to determine areas of elevated wildfire risk - per personal communication, exploring the use of additional local meteorological resources)	Yes (per personal communication, as of April 2025, utility is implementing mitigation system settings including disabling automatic reclosing)	Yes (per personal communication, as of April 2025, utility is implementing mitigation system settings including adjusting fault trip sensitivity)	Yes	Yes (per personal communication, sectionalization and advance notification of medical device customers)	2: WMP & PSPS plan, but otherwise incomplete
	Fortis (Arizona) UNS Energy / UniSource Energy Services	Yes	No (state and federal wildfire and emergency management websites used to determine areas of elevated wildfire risk - per personal communication, exploring the use of additional local meteorological resources)	Yes (per personal communication, as of April 2025, utility is implementing mitigation system settings including disabling automatic reclosing)	Yes (per personal communication, as of April 2025, utility is implementing mitigation system settings including adjusting fault trip sensitivity)	Yes	Yes (per personal communication, sectionalization and advance notification of medical device customers)	2: WMP & PSPS plan, but otherwise incomplete
	Morenci Water and Electric Company	No public plan available	No public plan available	No public plan available	No public plan available	No public plan available	No public plan available	3: No WMP, no PSPS plan, or no public information available

State	IOU	1. WMP information created & released?	2. Weather stations / other first-party meteorological resources?	3. Reclosing disabled in high fire-risk conditions?	4. Protective Equipment & Device Settings (PEDS) / Fast-Trip?	5. Operational PSPS plan?	6. Shutoff impact mitigation?	WMP Maturity Tier
California	Bear Valley Electric Service	Yes	Yes	Yes (automatic reclosing turned off during high-risk periods)	Yes (fast trip curve setting used on all devices)	Yes	Yes (sectionalization / fault isolation program, preemptive outreach including identification of medical baseline customers and preparation of community resource centers)	1: WMP & PSPS plan, all other criteria met
	Berkshire Hathaway (California) / PacifiCorp (California)	Yes	Yes	Yes (recloser disabling on transmission lines)	Yes (Elevated Fire Risk (EFR) modes of operation implemented on all California distribution circuits)	Yes	Yes (preemptive outreach including identification of medical baseline customers and preparation of community resource centers; sectionalization to reduce shutoff impact)	1: WMP & PSPS plan, all other criteria met
	Liberty Utilities (California)	Yes	Yes	Yes (alternate "Wildfire Mode" recloser settings can be enabled on high fire risk or red flag days)	Yes (alternate "Wildfire Mode" recloser settings can be enabled on high fire risk or red flag days)	Yes	Yes (preemptive outreach including identification of medical baseline customers and preparation of community resource centers; one microgrid project installed and installing reclosers to aid sectionalization)	1: WMP & PSPS plan, all other criteria met
	LS Power Grid (California) †	Yes	No (no existing weather monitoring systems currently in use; subscribes to external weather forecasting and intelligence service)	No (does not have service territory or any currently operating assets / end users)	No (does not have service territory or any currently operating assets / end users)	No (independent transmission operator without end users; does not currently own transmission lines)	No (does not have service territory or any currently operating assets / end users)	N/A (Transmission-only utility)
	NextEra Energy (California) Horizon West Transmission †	Yes	Yes	No (transmission-only utility; does not own, operate, or maintain electric distribution facilities)	No (transmission-only utility; does not own, operate, or maintain electric distribution facilities)	Yes	Yes (no retail customers, but protocol for communication with stakeholders like fire agencies in the event of a shutoff)	N/A (Transmission-only utility)
	Pacific Gas & Electric	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes (microgrids and community resource centers; preemptive outreach including advance notification and identification of medical baseline customers; sectionalization of distribution & transmission lines)	1: WMP & PSPS plan, all other criteria met
	Sempra (California) / San Diego Gas & Electric	Yes	Yes	Yes (automatic reclosing disabled year-round in high-threat areas)	Yes (more sensitive relay & recloser settings in high-threat areas depending on wildfire risk levels; installation of automated / advanced protection equipment)	Yes	Yes (preemptive outreach including identification of medical baseline customers and critical facilities in advance; providing portable renewable generators/ batteries to affected critical facilities, tribal communities and medically vulnerable customers; preparation of community resource centers; ongoing sectionalization program; 4 microgrid projects)	1: WMP & PSPS plan, all other criteria met

State	IOU	1. WMP information created & released?	2. Weather stations / other first-party meteorological resources?	3. Reclosing disabled in high fire-risk conditions?	4. Protective Equipment & Device Settings (PEDS) / Fast-Trip?	5. Operational PSPS plan?	6. Shutoff impact mitigation?	WMP Maturity Tier
California, continued	Southern California Edison	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes ("Fast Curve" settings for faster trip during high risk conditions)	Yes	Yes (advance identification and outreach to access and functional needs customers; community resource centers; installing sectionalization devices; assessing potential microgrids / remote grid pilots)	1: WMP & PSPS plan, all other criteria met
	Trans Bay Cable†	Yes	Yes (1 weather station at Pittsburg converter station)	No (all aboveground transmission infrastructure within the walls of converter stations; no distribution infrastructure)	No (all aboveground transmission infrastructure within the walls of converter stations; no distribution infrastructure)	No (transmission-only utility; does not own, operate, or maintain electric distribution facilities)	No (no end-use customers, service territory or distribution system)	N/A (Transmission-only utility)
Colorado	Black Hills Energy (Colorado)	Yes (combined Colorado, South Dakota, and Wyoming plan)	Yes (per personal communication, deploying weather stations)	Yes	No (per personal communication, utility operates protection devices that allow for faster de-energization of facilities once a fault is detected, is continuing to evaluate settings to allow faster trip)	Yes (per personal communication, PSPS measures in place by mid-year 2025)	Yes (per personal communication, deploying sectionalization devices)	2: WMP & PSPS plan, but otherwise incomplete
	Xcel Energy (Colorado) / Public Service Company of Colorado	Yes (draft 2025-27 WMP filed; WMP and PSPS plan also available at Colorado PUC under proceeding No. 24A-0296E)	Yes (per WMP pg. 60, utility is beginning to install weather stations in 2024 and will expand this weather station network in 2025-2027)	Yes (per WMP pg. 85)	Yes (per WMP pg. 87, pilot EPSS program began in 2020 and will expand through 2027; EPSS implemented in high-risk areas)	Yes	Yes (per WMP pg. 89 and PSPS plan pg. 28, planning to enhance access to identify and notify medical baseline customers in advance)	1: WMP & PSPS plan, all other criteria met
Florida	Chesapeake Utilities (Florida) / Florida Public Utilities Company	No public wildfire plan available (but see Storm Protection Plan)	No public plan available	No public plan available	No public plan available	No public plan available	No public plan available	3: No WMP, no PSPS plan, or no public information available
	Duke Energy (Florida)	No public Florida wildfire plan available (but see Storm Protection Plan)	No public plan available (Meteorological resources discussed in Carolinas climate resilience study)	No public plan available	No public plan available	No public plan available	No public plan available	3: No WMP, no PSPS plan, or no public information available
	Emera (Florida) / Tampa Electric Company	No public Florida wildfire plan available (but see Storm Protection Plan)	No public plan available (only post-storm data)	No public plan available	No public plan available	No public plan available	No public plan available	3: No WMP, no PSPS plan, or no public information available
	NextEra Energy (Florida) / Florida Power and Light Company / Gulf Power Company	No public Florida wildfire plan available (but see Storm Protection Plan)	No public plan available	No public plan available	No public plan available	No public plan available	No public plan available	3: No WMP, no PSPS plan, or no public information available
Georgia	Southern Company (Georgia) / Georgia Power	No public plan available	No public plan available	No public plan available	No public plan available	No public plan available	No public plan available	3: No WMP, no PSPS plan, or no public information available
Hawaii	Hawaii Electric / Hawaii Electric Light Company (Hawaii)	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes (sectionalization and advance identification of critical public safety customers)	1: WMP & PSPS plan, all other criteria met
	Hawaii Electric / Hawaiian Electric Company (Oahu)	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes (sectionalization and advance identification of critical public safety customers)	1: WMP & PSPS plan, all other criteria met
	Hawaii Electric / Maui Electric Company (Maui)	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes (sectionalization and advance identification of critical public safety customers)	1: WMP & PSPS plan, all other criteria met

State	IOU	1. WMP information created & released?	2. Weather stations / other first-party meteorological resources?	3. Reclosing disabled in high fire-risk conditions?	4. Protective Equipment & Device Settings (PEDS) / Fast-Trip?	5. Operational PSPS plan?	6. Shutoff impact mitigation?	WMP Maturity Tier
Idaho	Avista Utilities (Idaho)	Yes (combined Idaho and Washington plan)	Yes (per personal communication, weather stations deployed for 2025 wildfire season)	Yes (per WMP pg. 48)	Yes (per WMP pg. 48)	Yes	Yes (per PSPS plan pg. 23-24, advance identification & notification of medical baseline customers, community resource centers)	1: WMP & PSPS plan, all other criteria met
	Berkshire Hathaway (Idaho) / PacifiCorp (Idaho) / Rocky Mountain Power (Idaho)	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes (referred to as Elevated Fire Risk (EFR) settings)	Yes	Yes (advance identification & notification of medical baseline customers, community resource centers)	1: WMP & PSPS plan, all other criteria met
	Idaho Power Company (Idaho)	Yes (combined Idaho and Oregon plan)	Yes	Yes (auto-reclose turned off)	Yes (trip settings set to instantaneous lockout)	Yes	Yes (proactive communication to affected customers and public safety partners)	1: WMP & PSPS plan, all other criteria met
Kansas	Evergy, Inc. (Kansas) / Kansas City Power & Light / Westar Energy	No public plan available	No public plan available	No public plan available	No public plan available	No public plan available	No public plan available	3: No WMP, no PSPS plan, or no public information available
	Liberty Utilities (Kansas) / Empire District Electric Company	No public plan available	No public plan available	No public plan available	No public plan available	No public plan available	No public plan available	3: No WMP, no PSPS plan, or no public information available
Louisiana	American Electric Power (Louisiana) / SWEPCO (Louisiana)	No public plan available	No public plan available	No public plan available	No public plan available	No public plan available	No public plan available	3: No WMP, no PSPS plan, or no public information available
	Cleco	Yes (Wildfire addressed in press releases: Aug 24, 2023 and Aug 30, 2023)	No public plan available	Yes	No public plan available	No public plan available (per Aug 20, 2023 press release, "de-energizing high-voltage lines that are in the path of an impending wildfire")	No public plan available	3: No WMP, no PSPS plan, or no public information available
	Entergy (Louisiana)	Yes	No (uses National Weather Service data)	Yes (auto-reclose turned off)	No public plan available	Yes	No public plan available	WMP & PSPS plan, but otherwise incomplete
Michigan	Alpena Power Company	No public plan available	No public plan available	No public plan available	No public plan available	No public plan available	No public plan available	3: No WMP, no PSPS plan, or no public information available
	American Electric Power (Michigan) / Indiana Michigan Power Company (Michigan)	No public plan available	No public plan available	No public plan available	No public plan available	No public plan available	No public plan available	3: No WMP, no PSPS plan, or no public information available
	CMS Energy / Consumers Energy	Yes	No (per WMP, utility uses data from wildfire weather forecasting, enhanced inspections and wildfire risk modeling)	No (per WMP, installing remotely controlled line reclosers, but no discussion of recloser blocking)	No (per WMP, installing remotely controlled line reclosers, but no discussion of fast-trip settings)	No (per WMP, in the process of designing PSPS plan)	No (per WMP, in the process of designing PSPS plan)	3: No WMP, no PSPS plan, or no public information available
	DTE Energy Company	No public plan available	No public plan available	No public plan available	No public plan available	No public plan available	No public plan available	3: No WMP, no PSPS plan, or no public information available
	Upper Peninsula Power Company	No public plan available	No public plan available	No public plan available	No public plan available	No public plan available	No public plan available	3: No WMP, no PSPS plan, or no public information available
	WEC Energy Group (Michigan) / Upper Michigan Energy Resources Corporation / We Energies	No public plan available	No public plan available	No public plan available	No public plan available	No public plan available	No public plan available	3: No WMP, no PSPS plan, or no public information available
	Xcel Energy (Michigan) / Northern States Power Company - Wisconsin and Michigan (Michigan)	Yes (combined Michigan and Wisconsin plan)	No (per WMP pg. 15, planning to install weather stations)	Yes (per WMP pg. 24, all forms of Wildfire Safety Operations (WSO) disable automatic reclosing)	Yes (per WMP pg. 24, more advanced forms of Wildfire Safety Operations (WSO) enable faster trip settings)	Yes	Yes (per WMP pg. 27, advance identification and notification of critical customers)	2: WMP & PSPS plan, but otherwise incomplete

State	IOU	1. WMP information created & released?	2. Weather stations / other first-party meteorological resources?	3. Reclosing disabled in high fire-risk conditions?	4. Protective Equipment & Device Settings (PEDS) / Fast-Trip?	5. Operational PSPS plan?	6. Shutoff impact mitigation?	WMP Maturity Tier
Minnesota	ALLETE (Minnesota) / Minnesota Power	Yes (wildfire risk mitigation discussed in corporate sustainability report)	No public plan available	No public plan available	No public plan available	No public plan available	No public plan available	3: No WMP, no PSPS plan, or no public information available
	Northwestern Wisconsin Electric (Minnesota)	No public plan available	No public plan available	No public plan available	No public plan available	No public plan available	No public plan available	3: No WMP, no PSPS plan, or no public information available
	Otter Tail Power Company (Minnesota)	No public plan available (working on plans to reduce wildfire risk as of 2023)	No public plan available	No public plan available	No public plan available	No public plan available	No public plan available	3: No WMP, no PSPS plan, or no public information available
	Xcel Energy (Minnesota) / Northern States Power Company (Minnesota)	Yes (combined Minnesota, North Dakota, and South Dakota plan)	No (per WMP pg. 19, utility currently uses third party data but planning to install weather stations)	Yes (per WMP pg. 32, all forms of Wildfire Safety Operations (WSO) disable automatic reclosing)	Yes (per WMP pg. 32-33, more advanced forms of Wildfire Safety Operations (WSO) enable faster trip settings)	Yes	Yes (per WMP pg. 36, advance identification and notification of critical customers)	2: WMP & PSPS plan, but otherwise incomplete
Mississippi	Entergy (Mississippi)	Yes	No (uses National Weather Service data)	Yes (auto-reclose turned off)	No public plan available	Yes	No public plan available	2: WMP & PSPS plan, but otherwise incomplete
	Southern Company (Mississippi) / Mississippi Power Company	No public plan available	No public plan available	No public plan available	No public plan available	No public plan available	No public plan available	3: No WMP, no PSPS plan, or no public information available
Montana	Montana-Dakota Utilities Company (Montana)	No public plan available	No public plan available	No public plan available	No public plan available	No public plan available	No public plan available	3: No WMP, no PSPS plan, or no public information available
	NorthWestern Energy (Montana)	Yes (combined Montana, Nebraska, and South Dakota plan)	No internal weather monitoring; planning to deploy weather stations	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes (advance communication and emergency mobile generation)	2: WMP & PSPS plan, but otherwise incomplete
Nevada	Berkshire Hathaway (Nevada) / NV Energy	Yes (as part of Natural Disaster Protection Plan filed with Public Utilities Commission)	Yes (weather stations and cameras installed)	Yes	Yes (per personal communications, Fast Trip Fire Mode (FTFM) deployed in high-risk areas)	Yes (as PSOM plan)	Yes (advance identification & notification of medical baseline customers, community resource centers, microgrid for Kyle Canyon circuit during shutoff - per personal communication, sectionalization)	1: WMP & PSPS plan, all other criteria met
New Mexico	El Paso Electric (New Mexico)	No (wildfire preparation discussed in 2021 Sustainability Report)	No public plan available	No public plan available	No public plan available	No public plan available	No public plan available	3: No WMP, no PSPS plan, or no public information available
	TXNM Energy (New Mexico) / Public Service Company of New Mexico	Yes	Yes (per personal communication, operates several weather stations with further deployment planned)	Yes (per personal communication, uses recloser blocking)	Yes (per personal communication, enhanced settings and dynamic protective devices installed on high-risk feeders)	Yes	Yes (advance identification & notification of medical baseline customers and community resource centers; per personal communication, sectionalization and community outreach plans in progress)	1: WMP & PSPS plan, all other criteria met
	Xcel Energy (New Mexico) / Southwestern Public Service Company (New Mexico)	Yes (combined New Mexico and Texas plan)	No (per WMP pg. 29, utility currently uses third party data; planning to install weather stations)	Yes (per WMP pg. 31, automatic reclosing blocked)	Yes (per WMP pg. 31)	Yes	Yes (advance communication and notification to affected customers)	2: WMP & PSPS plan, but otherwise incomplete
North Carolina	Dominion Energy (North Carolina)	No public plan available	No public plan available	No public plan available	No public plan available	No public plan available	No public plan available	3: No WMP, no PSPS plan, or no public information available
	Duke Energy (North Carolina) / Duke Energy Carolinas (North Carolina) / Duke Energy Progress (North Carolina)	No public plan available (wildfire risk and potential future adaptations discussed in Climate Resilience & Adaptation Plan)	No public plan available	No public plan available	No public plan available	No public plan available	No public plan available	3: No WMP, no PSPS plan, or no public information available

State	IOU	1. WMP information created & released?	2. Weather stations / other first-party meteorological resources?	3. Reclosing disabled in high fire-risk conditions?	4. Protective Equipment & Device Settings (PEDS) / Fast-Trip?	5. Operational PSPS plan?	6. Shutoff impact mitigation?	WMP Maturity Tier
North Dakota	Montana-Dakota Utilities Company (North Dakota)	No public plan available	No public plan available	No public plan available	No public plan available	No public plan available	No public plan available	3: No WMP, no PSPS plan, or no public information available
	Otter Tail Power Company (North Dakota)	No public plan available (working on plans to reduce wildfire risk as of 2023)	No public plan available	No public plan available	No public plan available	No public plan available	No public plan available	3: No WMP, no PSPS plan, or no public information available
	Xcel Energy (North Dakota) / Northern States Power Company (North Dakota)	Yes (combined Minnesota, North Dakota, and South Dakota plan)	No (per WMP pg. 19, utility currently uses third party data but planning to install weather stations)	Yes (per WMP pg. 32, all forms of Wildfire Safety Operations (WSO) disable automatic reclosing)	Yes (per WMP pg. 32-33, more advanced forms of Wildfire Safety Operations (WSO) enable faster trip settings)	Yes	Yes (per WMP pg. 36, advance identification and notification of critical customers)	2: WMP & PSPS plan, but otherwise incomplete
Oklahoma	American Electric Power (Oklahoma) / Public Service Company of Oklahoma	No public plan available	No public plan available	No public plan available	No public plan available	No public plan available	No public plan available	3: No WMP, no PSPS plan, or no public information available
	Liberty Utilities (Oklahoma) / Empire District Electric Company (Oklahoma)	No Oklahoma plan available (WMP for California)	No public plan available	No public plan available	No public plan available	No public plan available	No public plan available	3: No WMP, no PSPS plan, or no public information available
	Oklahoma Gas & Electric	No public plan available (2023 fire news release)	No public plan available	No public plan available	No public plan available	No public plan available (Considered de-energizing lines during 2025 fires)	No public plan available	3: No WMP, no PSPS plan, or no public information available
Oregon	Berkshire Hathaway (Oregon) / PacifiCorp (Oregon) / Pacific Power	Yes (with 2025 update)	Yes	Yes (Elevated Fire Risk (EFR settings) modes of operation can be set to prevent reclosing)	Yes (Elevated Fire Risk (EFR settings) modes of operation can be set to increase sensitivity)	Yes	Yes (advance communication & notification, community resource centers)	1: WMP & PSPS plan, all other criteria met
	Idaho Power Company (Oregon)	Yes (combined Idaho and Oregon plan)	Yes	Yes (auto-reclose turned off)	Yes (trip settings set to instantaneous lockout)	Yes	Yes (proactive communication to affected customers and public safety partners)	1: WMP & PSPS plan, all other criteria met
	Portland General Electric	Yes (with 2025 update)	Yes	Yes (reclosing blocked during fire season & red flag warnings)	Yes (fast-trip used during fire season & red flag warnings)	Yes	Yes (advance communication & notification, community resource centers, and medical battery support)	1: WMP & PSPS plan, all other criteria met
South Carolina	Dominion Energy (South Carolina)	No public plan available	No public plan available	No public plan available	No public plan available	No public plan available	No public plan available	3: No WMP, no PSPS plan, or no public information available
	Duke Energy (South Carolina) / Duke Energy Carolinas (South Carolina) / Duke Energy Progress (South Carolina)	No public plan available (wildfire risk and potential future adaptations discussed in Climate Resilience & Adaptation Plan)	No public plan available	No public plan available	No public plan available	No public plan available	No public plan available	3: No WMP, no PSPS plan, or no public information available
	Pacolet Milliken / Lockhart Power	No public plan available	No public plan available	No public plan available	No public plan available	No public plan available	No public plan available	3: No WMP, no PSPS plan, or no public information available

State	IOU	1. WMP information created & released?	2. Weather stations / other first-party meteorological resources?	3. Reclosing disabled in high fire-risk conditions?	4. Protective Equipment & Device Settings (PEDS) / Fast-Trip?	5. Operational PSPS plan?	6. Shutoff impact mitigation?	WMP Maturity Tier
South Dakota	Berkshire Hathaway (South Dakota) / MidAmerican Energy Co (South Dakota)	No (per personal communication)	No (per personal communication)	No (per personal communication)	No (per personal communication)	No (per personal communication)	No (per personal communication)	3: No WMP, no PSPS plan, or no public information available
	Black Hills Energy (South Dakota)	Yes (combined Colorado, South Dakota, and Wyoming plan)	Yes (per personal communication, deploying weather stations)	Yes	No (per personal communication, utility operates protection devices that allow for faster de-energization of facilities once a fault is detected, is continuing to evaluate settings to allow faster trip)	Yes (per personal communication, PSPS measures in place by mid-year 2025)	Yes (per personal communication, deploying sectionalization devices)	2: WMP & PSPS plan, but otherwise incomplete
	Montana-Dakota Utilities Company (South Dakota)	No public plan available	No public plan available	No public plan available	No public plan available	No public plan available	No public plan available	3: No WMP, no PSPS plan, or no public information available
	NorthWestern Energy (South Dakota)	Yes (combined Montana, Nebraska, and South Dakota plan)	No internal weather monitoring; planning to deploy weather stations	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes (advance communication and emergency mobile generation)	2: WMP & PSPS plan, but otherwise incomplete
	Otter Tail Power Company (South Dakota)	No public plan available (working on plans to reduce wildfire risk as of 2023)	No public plan available	No public plan available	No public plan available	No public plan available	No public plan available	3: No WMP, no PSPS plan, or no public information available
	Xcel Energy (South Dakota) / Northern States Power Company (South Dakota)	Yes (combined Minnesota, North Dakota, and South Dakota plan)	No (per WMP pg. 19, utility currently uses third party data but planning to install weather stations)	Yes (per WMP pg. 32, all forms of Wildfire Safety Operations (WSO) disable automatic reclosing)	Yes (per WMP pg. 32-33, more advanced forms of Wildfire Safety Operations (WSO) enable faster trip settings)	Yes	Yes (per WMP pg. 36, advance identification and notification of critical customers)	2: WMP & PSPS plan, but otherwise incomplete
Texas	American Electric Power (Texas) / AEP Texas	Yes (wildfire mitigation discussed in systemwide resiliency plan and emergency operations plans filed with Texas PUC)	No public plan available	Yes (upgrading circuit breakers to allow remote recloser blocking)	No public plan available	No public plan available	No public plan available	3: No WMP, no PSPS plan, or no public information available
	American Electric Power (Texas) / SWEPCO (Texas)	Yes (wildfire risk discussed in systemwide resiliency plan and emergency operations plan filed with Texas PUC)	No public plan available	No public plan available	No public plan available	No public plan available	No public plan available	3: No WMP, no PSPS plan, or no public information available
	American Electric Power (Texas) & Berkshire Hathaway (Texas) / Electric Transmission Texas†	Yes (wildfire risk discussed in emergency operations plan filed with Texas PUC)	No public plan available	No public plan available	No public plan available	No public plan available	No public plan available	N/A (Transmission-only utility)
	CenterPoint Energy (Texas)	Yes (wildfire mitigation discussed in systemwide resiliency plan and emergency operations plan filed with Texas PUC)	Yes (Weather stations purchased for 2025 fire season)	Yes	Yes (installing intelligent grid switching devices (IGSD) on distribution network and adjusting safety settings during high-risk conditions)	Yes	Yes (sectionalization)	1: WMP & PSPS plan, all other criteria met
	El Paso Electric (Texas)	No public plan available (wildfire preparation discussed in 2021 Sustainability Report)	No public plan available	No public plan available	No public plan available	No public plan available (confidential emergency operations plan)	No public plan available	3: No WMP, no PSPS plan, or no public information available
	Entergy (Texas)	Yes (wildfire mitigation discussed in emergency operations plan and systemwide resiliency plan filed with Texas PUC)	No (uses National Weather Service data)	Yes (auto-reclosing blocked)	No public plan available	Yes	No public plan available	2: WMP & PSPS plan, but otherwise incomplete

State	IOU	1. WMP information created & released?	2. Weather stations / other first-party meteorological resources?	3. Reclosing disabled in high fire-risk conditions?	4. Protective Equipment & Device Settings (PEDS) / Fast-Trip?	5. Operational PSPS plan?	6. Shutoff impact mitigation?	WMP Maturity Tier
Texas, continued	LS Power Grid (Texas) / Cross Texas Transmission†	No public plan available	No public plan available	No public plan available	No public plan available	No public plan available (confidential emergency operations plan)	No public plan available	N/A (Transmission-only utility)
	NextEra Energy (Texas) / Lone Star Transmission LLC†	No public Texas plan available (emergency operations plan filed with Texas PUC)	No public plan available	No public plan available	No public plan available	No (confidential emergency operations plan)	No public plan available	N/A (Transmission-only utility)
	Sempra (Texas) / Oncor Electric Delivery	Yes (wildfire mitigation discussed in systemwide resiliency plan and emergency operations plan filed with Texas PUC)	No (considering use of weather stations and camera networks)	Yes (remote adjustment of relay settings enabled for wildfire mitigation)	No public plan available (remote adjustment of relay settings enabled for wildfire mitigation)	No public plan available (but has capability to remotely de-energize power lines)	Yes (sectionalization to isolate faulted segments)	3: No WMP, no PSPS plan, or no public information available
	TXNM Energy (Texas) / Texas-New Mexico Power Company	Yes (wildfire mitigation discussed in systemwide resiliency plan and emergency operations plan filed with Texas PUC)	Yes (currently uses third-party data per emergency operations plan; planning to deploy weather stations per systemwide resiliency plan; per personal communication, weather station mesonet active for 2025 fire season)	Yes (reclosing blocked or limited)	Yes (per personal communication, deploying protective equipment starting in 2025)	No ("proactive de-energization" discussed in emergency operations plan filed with Texas PUC; per personal communication, currently evaluating the prospect of developing a Public Safety Power Shutoff plan)	No public plan available (planning to implement sectionalization for shutoff events and advance communication to areas at heightened risk)	3: No WMP, no PSPS plan, or no public information available
	Xcel Energy (Texas) / Southwestern Public Service Company (Texas)	Yes (combined New Mexico and Texas plan; wildfire mitigation discussed in systemwide resiliency plan and emergency operations plan filed with Texas PUC)	No (per WMP pg. 29, utility currently uses third party data; planning to install weather stations)	Yes (per WMP pg. 31, automatic reclosing blocked)	Yes (per WMP pg. 31)	Yes	Yes (advance communication and notification to affected customers)	2: WMP & PSPS plan, but otherwise incomplete
	Wind Energy Transmission Texas†	No public plan available (wildfire risk discussed in emergency operations plan filed with Texas PUC)	No public plan available	No public plan available	No public plan available	No (confidential emergency operations plan)	No public plan available	N/A (Transmission-only utility)
Utah	Berkshire Hathaway (Utah) / PacifiCorp (Utah) / Rocky Mountain Power (Utah)	Yes	Yes	Yes (Elevated Fire Risk (EFR settings) modes of operation can be set to prevent reclosing)	Yes (Elevated Fire Risk (EFR settings) modes of operation can be set to increase sensitivity)	Yes	Yes (advance communication & notification, community resource centers)	1: WMP & PSPS plan, all other criteria met
Washington	Avista Utilities (Washington)	Yes (combined Idaho and Washington plan)	Yes (per personal communication, weather stations deployed for 2025 wildfire season)	Yes (per WMP pg. 48)	Yes (per WMP pg. 48)	Yes	Yes (per PSPS plan pg. 23-24, advance identification & notification of medical baseline customers, community resource centers)	1: WMP & PSPS plan, all other criteria met
	Berkshire Hathaway (Washington) / PacifiCorp (Washington) / Pacific Power	Yes	Yes	Yes (alternative operating mode used to limit reclosing)	Yes (alternative operating mode used to increase fault sensitivity and speed)	Yes	Yes (advance communication & notification, community resource centers)	1: WMP & PSPS plan, all other criteria met
	Puget Sound Energy (Washington)	Yes (as Wildfire Mitigation & Response Plan)	Yes (per WMP pg. 32)	Yes (reclosing blocked on targeted power lines)	Yes (more sensitive settings used on targeted power lines)	Yes	Yes (per WMP pg. 43-44, advance identification and notification of medical baseline customers, community resource centers)	1: WMP & PSPS plan, all other criteria met

State	IOU	1. WMP information created & released?	2. Weather stations / other first-party meteorological resources?	3. Reclosing disabled in high fire-risk conditions?	4. Protective Equipment & Device Settings (PEDS) / Fast-Trip?	5. Operational PSPS plan?	6. Shutoff impact mitigation?	WMP Maturity Tier
Wisconsin	ALLETE (Wisconsin) / Superior Water, Light & Power Company	No public plan available	No public plan available	No public plan available	No public plan available	No public plan available	No public plan available	3: No WMP, no PSPS plan, or no public information available
	Alliant Energy (Wisconsin) / Wisconsin Power & Light	No public plan available	No public plan available	No public plan available	No public plan available	No public plan available	No public plan available	3: No WMP, no PSPS plan, or no public information available
	American Transmission Company (Wisconsin)†	No public plan available (fire risk discussed in operating plan agreement with Hiawatha National Forest)	no public plan available	No public plan available	No public plan available	No public plan available	No public plan available	N/A (Transmission-only utility)
	Consolidated Water Power Company	No public plan available	No public plan available	No public plan available	No public plan available	No public plan available	No public plan available	3: No WMP, no PSPS plan, or no public information available
	Dahlberg Light and Power Company	No public plan available	No public plan available	No public plan available	No public plan available	No public plan available	No public plan available	3: No WMP, no PSPS plan, or no public information available
	Madison Gas and Electric	No public plan available	No public plan available	No public plan available	No public plan available	No public plan available	No public plan available	3: No WMP, no PSPS plan, or no public information available
	North Central Power Company	No public plan available	No public plan available	No public plan available	No public plan available	No public plan available	No public plan available	3: No WMP, no PSPS plan, or no public information available
	Northwestern Wisconsin Electric (Wisconsin)	No public plan available	No public plan available	No public plan available	No public plan available	No public plan available	No public plan available	3: No WMP, no PSPS plan, or no public information available
	Pioneer Power and Light Company / Westfield Milling and Electric Light Company	No public plan available	No public plan available	No public plan available	No public plan available	No public plan available	No public plan available	3: No WMP, no PSPS plan, or no public information available
	Xcel Energy (Wisconsin) / Northern States Power Company - Wisconsin and Michigan (Wisconsin)	Yes (combined Michigan & Wisconsin plan)	No (per WMP pg. 15, planning to install weather stations)	Yes (per WMP pg. 24, all forms of Wildfire Safety Operations (WSO) disable automatic reclosing)	Yes (per WMP pg. 24, more advanced forms of Wildfire Safety Operations (WSO) enable faster trip settings)	Yes	Yes (per WMP pg. 27, advance identification and notification of critical customers)	2: WMP & PSPS plan, but otherwise incomplete
	WEC Energy Group (Wisconsin) / Wisconsin Electric Power Company / Wisconsin Public Service Corporation	No public plan available	No public plan available	No public plan available	No public plan available	No public plan available	No public plan available	3: No WMP, no PSPS plan, or no public information available
Wyoming	Berkshire Hathaway (Wyoming) / PacifiCorp (Wyoming) / Rocky Mountain Power (Wyoming)	Yes	Yes	Yes (Elevated Fire Risk (EFR Settings) modes of operation can be set to limit reclosing)	Yes (Elevated Fire Risk (EFR settings) modes of operation can be set to increase sensitivity)	Yes	Yes (advance communication & notification, community resource centers)	1: WMP & PSPS plan, all other criteria met
	Black Hills Energy (Wyoming)	Yes (combined Colorado, South Dakota, and Wyoming plan)	Yes (per personal communication, deploying weather stations)	Yes	No (per personal communication, utility operates protection devices that allow for faster de-energization of facilities once a fault is detected, is continuing to evaluate settings to allow faster trip)	Yes (per personal communication, PSPS measures in place by mid-year 2025)	Yes (per personal communication, deploying sectionalization devices)	2: WMP & PSPS plan, but otherwise incomplete
	Montana-Dakota Utilities Company (Wyoming)	No public plan available	No public plan available	No public plan available	No public plan available	No public plan available	No public plan available	3: No WMP, no PSPS plan, or no public information available

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